

If you answered A, you're a lucky dog. You have parents who are able, or at least willing, to foot the bill for your postsecondary education. And if they're willing to support you during school so you don't have to have a job that will distract you from your studies, all the more fortunate. Get good grades, graduate at the top of your class, and at least demonstrate it was a great investment for them.

If you answered B, good for you. You used your smarts to reap financial rewards. Keep finding ways to do that, and you're set for life.

If you answered C, then at least be certain this is the kind of investment you want to make in yourself. A loan is a huge responsibility, your first one, so don't take it on lightly.

If you answered D, then I admire your fortitude. Still, there's nothing wrong with taking six months or a year *after* high school to work and save some more money. No one says you have to graduate when you're twenty-one or twenty-two. If working for a year means not carrying a heavy debt load, or not working too hard while studying, then by all means I suggest you delay college, especially if it means curbing your debt load later.

4. You've decided that your living arrangements at college will be:

- a) very manageable—financially, at least—because you've picked a school close to home and will therefore stay in your old room.
- b) dorm-room style. And you're hoping the school matches you up with a decent roommate.
- c) a shared apartment. You've met three strangers on Craigslist and you're sharing the cost of a house.
- d) the last thing you're going to scrimp on. You deserve luxury, and you need it in order to pull off good grades. That's why you're splurging on that awesome off-campus pad.

No matter what option you circled, housing is going to be your biggest cost, so keep your needs minimal and your overhead low.

If you answered A, remember that living at home does not mean a free ticket. To be a responsible adult means contributing to your household in ways that you didn't when you lived there in high